

Reporting Format Guide

Admin Operations and Configuration Manual

Manual 13 of 25
Route: /metro2-compliance
Group: Legal & Rules
Generated: May 10, 2026

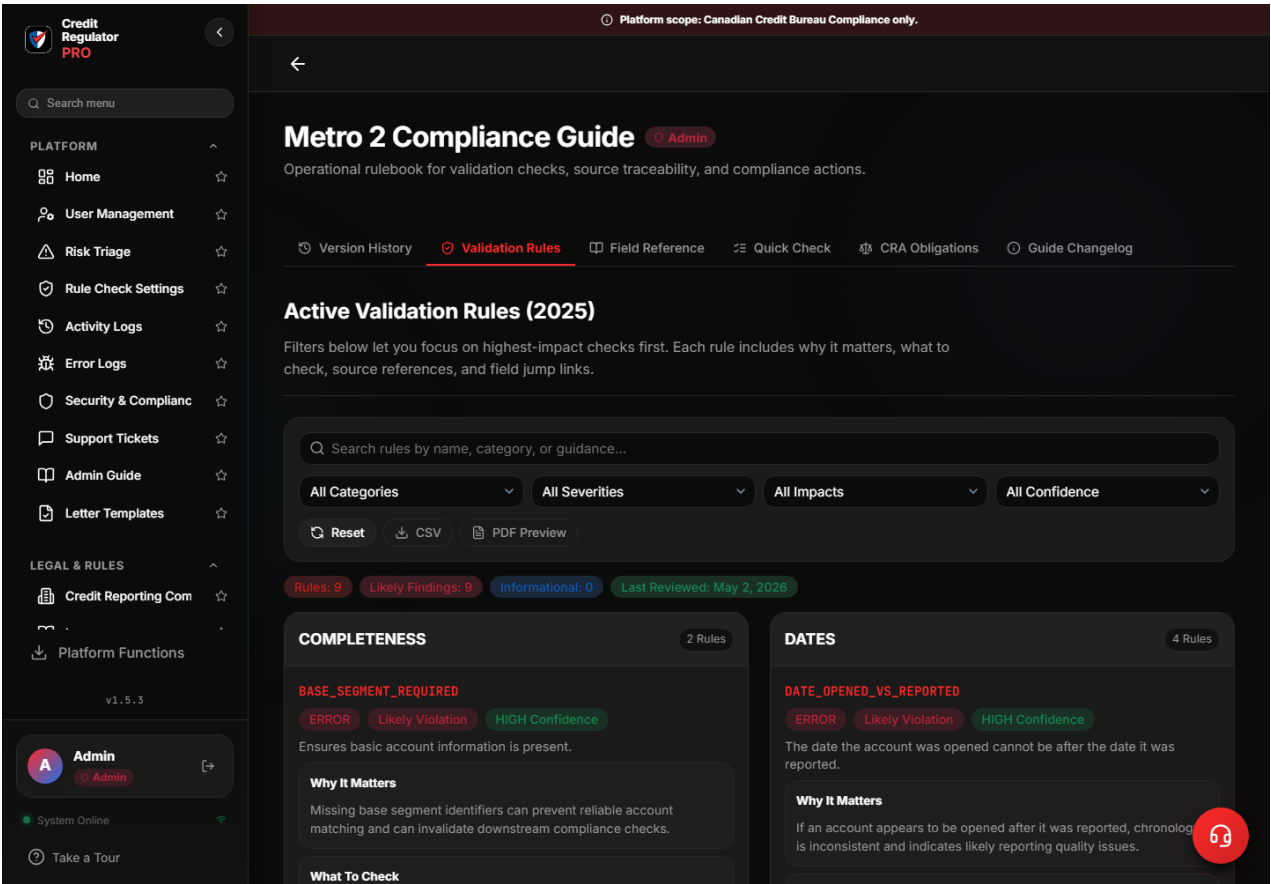
1. Section Overview

Reporting Format Guide explains credit-reporting format expectations, field meanings, and Metro 2 style concepts used during parser, mapping, and compliance review.

Use this section to interpret report fields, distinguish formatting problems from legal findings, and support parser mapping decisions.

2. Current Admin Screenshot

Screenshot source: localhost development admin environment with test data. Test data is permitted for these manuals and should still be treated as internal.



The screenshot shows guide content, field/reference groupings, and examples used for report-format interpretation.

3. Access and Operating Rules

- Sign in with an account that has admin access. Support users may see some reference sections, but admin configuration and review tools require admin role.
- Use the intended environment. Local admin browser testing uses `http://localhost:5175`. The backend port, `http://localhost:3333`, is API-only.
- Treat screenshots, exports, logs, report text, and record IDs as internal test-environment material. Do not paste them into public channels.
- Confirm the page route, active filters, selected user, selected report, and selected environment before any save, delete, reset, dismissal, or finalize action.
- When an action affects customer-facing findings, packets, pricing, feature flags, or parser truth, record the reason and verify the downstream record after refresh.
- A format issue is not automatically a confirmed legal violation.
- Use exact field paths and source excerpts when documenting parser defects.
- Report-format guidance should inform parser mapping and evidence review.

4. Screen Anatomy and Controls

Area	What it means	Admin procedure
Format concepts	Explain account fields, dates, balances, statuses, and reporting structures.	Use when a parser output field needs meaning, not legal classification.
Examples	Show malformed, inconsistent, or expected data patterns.	Compare to source report text before creating a parser correction.
Reference entries	Support mapping decisions and terminology.	Use exact field names in correction notes.

5. Step-by-Step Instructions

Interpret a report field

Use when a parser field or finding references a report term that needs clarification.

Procedure

1. Open Reporting Format Guide and search for the field or concept.
2. Read the meaning, expected format, and common variants.
3. Compare the guide to the source report text or PDF view.
4. Open Parser Testing if the parser mapped the field incorrectly.
5. Open Laws or obligation pages only if the question is legal duty rather than data format.

Verification

- The field meaning is documented with exact source context.

- Parser and legal issues are separated in the admin note.

Support parser mapping decisions

Use when a report layout causes fields to land in the wrong platform property.

Procedure

1. Identify the source field label, neighboring labels, and account section from the report.
2. Open Reporting Format Guide and confirm the target field meaning.
3. Open Parser Mappings and search for existing mappings by bureau and field name.
4. If no mapping exists or the mapping is stale, document the expected field path and source evidence.
5. Create a parser correction or mapping update request with exact terms and examples.

Verification

- The mapping request includes source label, target field, bureau/layout, and evidence.

6. Common Tasks With Drilldown Examples

Distinguish missing field from not reported

Example: A date appears blank in parser output.

Drilldown procedure

1. Open the source report text or PDF.
2. Use the guide to determine whether the field is normally expected for that account type.
3. If the bureau reports the value but parser missed it, save Missing From Parser in adjudication.
4. If the bureau did not report it, mark Not Reported By Bureau where the correction workflow supports it.
5. If legal authority for exact-field requirements is missing, keep the issue review-only.

Best practices for this task

- Do not convert ordinary missing data into legal violation findings without exact authority.
- Use source evidence to separate parser defects from source absence.

Done when

- Correction decision matches what the bureau actually reported.

Explain a malformed field

Example: A payment history string appears inconsistent.

Drilldown procedure

1. Locate the source string in raw text or PDF.
2. Open Reporting Format Guide and review expected formatting.
3. Compare length, symbols, dates, and neighboring account context.
4. Open Risk Triage or Finding Corrections only if the malformed field generated a finding.
5. Document the exact string and why it is malformed.

Best practices for this task

- Keep the explanation focused on format unless legal authority is separately mapped.

Done when

- The malformed-field note includes exact source text and target interpretation.

7. Configuration and Change-Control Scope

- This page is reference content, not a direct detector switch.
- Insights from this page may lead to parser mappings, rule changes, or correction notes.
- Do not use format concepts to overstate legal outcomes.

8. Common Errors

Problem	Likely cause	Admin response
Access denied or redirected to login	The session expired, the role is not admin, or the wrong environment is open.	Sign back in, confirm admin role, and reopen the route from the sidebar instead of using an old bookmark.
Expected record is missing	Search terms, tabs, filters, pagination, or environment selection are hiding the record.	Clear filters, search by exact ID or email, verify the environment, and compare Activity Logs when available.
Save appears to do nothing	Required fields are missing, there are no dirty changes, or the API returned a validation error.	Read the inline validation text, correct one field at a time, save again, refresh, and check Error Logs if the state still does not persist.
reporting format guide state conflicts with another page	The source record was changed elsewhere or the current page is stale.	Refresh the page, reopen the source record, and use timestamps or record IDs to decide which state is authoritative.

9. Troubleshooting

Check	Why it matters	How to proceed
Start with a refresh	A refresh confirms whether the reporting format guide view is stale or whether the backend rejected the action.	Refresh once, then repeat the exact search or selection. Do not repeat destructive actions until the latest state is visible.
Check Activity Logs	Successful admin actions should leave an audit trail for sensitive workflows.	Search by actor, affected user, entity ID, route, or timestamp. Use the log entry as confirmation, not just the toast message.
Check Error Logs	Repeated UI failures usually have matching server or API errors.	Search around the action time. Capture the route, status, error summary, and request context for developer follow-up.

Check	Why it matters	How to proceed
Escalate with evidence	Developer review is faster when the exact record and reproduction path are known.	Provide environment, route, selected filters, record ID, expected outcome, actual outcome, screenshot, and timestamp.

10. Best Practices

- Use exact field names and source excerpts.
- Separate format, parser, and legal issues.
- Treat blank values carefully: missing from parser and not reported by bureau are different.
- Back mapping decisions with deterministic fixtures where possible.

11. Completion Checklist

- The reporting format guide page was reopened or refreshed after the change.
- The expected saved state remained visible after refresh.
- Related logs, downstream records, or generated artifacts agree with the visible page state.
- Any customer-facing wording, finding status, packet state, or support note was reviewed for factual and neutral language.
- Any unresolved risk, failed test, suspicious log, or unclear source evidence was escalated with record IDs and screenshots.

12. Related Admin Areas

- Parser Testing
- Parser Mappings
- Finding Corrections
- Laws
- Risk Triage